

Chain Accountability Protocol - (CAP)

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Accountability Navigation Layer
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Canonical Definition

Chain Accountability Protocol (CAP) defines a structured governance investigation and accountability navigation protocol used to identify, validate, reconstruct, analyze, and govern accountability relationships across complete governance chains.

CAP provides a systematic methodology for tracing accountability from outcome to origin through relationship structures, authority structures, responsibility structures, capability conditions, control environments, oversight environments, evidence environments, accountability relationships, decision environments, accountability continuity environments, and accountability chains.

CAP operates as the practical navigation protocol of the Accountability Governance Architecture (AGA™).

Purpose

The purpose of CAP is to provide a repeatable governance methodology capable of determining:

- who was involved
 - who had authority
 - who had responsibility
 - who was capable of acting
 - who exercised control
 - who provided oversight
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- what evidence exists
- who remains accountable
- who made decisions
- whether accountability remained preserved
- how accountability traveled across governance structures

Core Question

How can accountability be reconstructed across a complete governance chain?

Protocol Structure

Phase 1 — Relationship Discovery

Standard Used: Relationship Accountability Standard (RAS)

Core Question:

Who was in the relationship?

Objective:

Identify all actors participating in the operational reality.

Output:

Relationship Map.

Phase 2 — Authority Analysis

Standards Used:

- Authority Governance Standard (AGS)
- Authority Validation Standard (AVS)
- Authority Delegation Standard (ADS)
- Authority Escalation Standard (AES)

Core Question:

Who could act?

Objective:

Identify authority ownership, validation, delegation, and escalation pathways.

Output:

Authority Map.

Phase 3 — Responsibility Analysis

Standards Used:

- Responsibility Governance Standard (RGS)
- Responsibility Assignment Standard (RAS-A)
- Responsibility Continuity Standard (RCS)
- Responsibility Traceability Standard (RTS)

Core Question:

Who had responsibility?

Objective:

Identify responsibility ownership and responsibility evolution.

Output:

Responsibility Map.

Phase 4 — Capability Verification

Standard Used:

Capability Readiness Governance Standard (CRGS)

Core Question:

Was the actor capable of acting?

Objective:

Verify capability readiness.

Output:

Capability Assessment.

Phase 5 — Control Analysis

Standard Used:

Chain of Control Standard (CCS)

Core Question:

Who actually controlled the outcome?

Objective:

Identify operational control structures.

Output:

Phase 6 — Oversight Analysis

Standard Used:

Governance Oversight Standard (GOS)

Core Question:

Who should have supervised?

Objective:

Identify oversight structures and oversight failures.

Output:

Oversight Assessment.

Phase 7 — Evidence Validation

Standard Used:

Evidence Accountability Standard (EAS)

Core Question:

What do the facts prove?

Objective:

Validate evidentiary foundations.

Output:

Evidence Set.

Phase 8 — Accountability Analysis

Standard Used:

Accountability Governance Standard (AGS-A)

Core Question:

Who remains answerable?

Objective:

Determine accountability ownership.

Output:

Phase 9 — Decision Accountability Analysis

Standard Used:

Decision Accountability Standard (DAS)

Core Question:

Who made the decision?

Objective:

Identify accountable decision-makers.

Output:

Decision Accountability Map.

Phase 10 — Accountability Continuity Analysis

Standard Used:

Accountability Continuity Standard (ACS)

Core Question:

Did accountability remain preserved?

Objective:

Verify accountability continuity throughout operational reality.

Output:

Continuity Assessment.

Phase 11 — Accountability Chain Reconstruction

Standard Used:

Accountability Chain Standard (ACS-C)

Core Question:

How did accountability travel across the governance chain?

Objective:

Reconstruct complete accountability pathways.

Output:

Final Protocol Outputs

CAP produces:

- Relationship Map
 - Authority Map
 - Responsibility Map
 - Capability Assessment
 - Control Map
 - Oversight Assessment
 - Evidence Set
 - Accountability Map
 - Decision Accountability Map
 - Accountability Continuity Assessment
 - Accountability Chain Map
 - Governance Failure Analysis
 - Accountability Gap Analysis
 - Consequence Attribution Analysis
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Foundational Principle

Governance becomes trustworthy when accountability can be reconstructed from consequence back to origin through a complete and auditable governance chain.

Canonical Closing Statement

Chain Accountability Protocol (CAP) provides the operational investigation and accountability navigation methodology of the Accountability Governance Architecture (AGA™). CAP transforms governance investigation from isolated observations into a structured accountability reconstruction process capable of identifying relationships, authority, responsibility, control, evidence, accountability, decision ownership, continuity, and accountability chains across complex governance environments.

Related Documents

→ [CAP™ — Chain of Accountability Protocol](#)

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Canonical Source

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